

IS OPTIMISM OVERRATED?

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You are sporting a brand-new, crisp white shirt, ready for the office, grabbing your Starbucks. Just as you're about to make your grand exit, a pint-sized tornado in the form of a kid whirls around, colliding with your coffee-filled cup. There goes your brand-new, crisp white shirt.

Choose the most apt option:

- 1) It is coffee art now, I don't mind being a trendsetter.
- 2) I'm going to go back and change, this would waste some of my time and the office I have to be in might catch a fire or blow-up. So, it definitely happened for a reason.
- 3) It's okay. I am happy because it is Starbucks that I spilt. At least I'm in a position in life to be affording one!
- 4) No worries, this shirt was just a distraction from my dazzling personality anyway.
- 5) Time to turn this wardrobe malfunction into a coffee-themed photoshoot.
- 6) Stain? Nah, it's a conversation starter. "OMG is that spilled coffee on a perfectly clean shirt?"

Optimism to me is like adorning the elephant in the room with colorful sticky notes of pretty affirmations from its head to its toenails. Sure, the elephant is now decorated, but the undeniable truth remains – there's an elephant in the room!! Does it really matter if it looks pretty?

No. It makes more sense to me to accept the fact that an unfortunate event has occurred, and there's nothing good about it and it can't be changed, there may or might not be lessons that are learnt and it is okay. There is zero requirement to be optimistic. Accepting that you are not going to be happy about all the outcomes in your life is a valuable lesson. Some may think of acceptance as an invitation to dwell in unhappiness, but that's a misconception. It's about recognizing that not every situation warrants a positive spin and being okay with that. In essence, it's about embracing the presence of the elephant in the room. Figure out ways to lead it out or accept the fact that with time it shall walk away. This encourages a balanced and realistic approach to life, recognizing that not every situation needs to be viewed through an overly optimistic lens. Optimism, in its relentless pursuit of positivity, may sometimes veer into illusion and self-gaslighting. It could encourage the belief that nothing has gone wrong, even when it has. On the other hand, acceptance provides the strength to move forward and offers pragmatic solutions. There is no way you can go wrong or face any disappointment by accepting what has been bestowed upon you. Optimism allows you to see your favorite side of the coin all the time, while acceptance is knowing there are two sides to a coin and what befalls when a situation is tossed is unexpected.

In conclusion, while optimism may have its place in certain situations, acceptance offers a more nuanced and realistic approach to life. It empowers us to face the complexities of our experiences with strength and authenticity to face life's intricacies, understanding that not every circumstance demands a rose-tinted perspective.